

Knowing God Is Loving People

Hallelujah, Jesus. Hallelujah.

"For I have desired to teach My people the love, the agape," is what He is talking about, "the love that is of the new nature. For that is a nature like My own. You can tell when you are walking in My love by when you love the brethren."

Hallelujah. When you love the brethren.

This seems to be really important to Him. It seems to be really important to God that the new nature He has given you sometime in your life end up giving itself to agape.

When He talked about forgiveness, He said:

So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

That is the end of a teaching Jesus did on the greatest in the kingdom. Who is the greatest? Who demands the most respect from the corporate structure of heaven? Who is this person heaven respects?

He finishes the teaching with anyone who has developed to the capacity to forgive his brother every one of his trespasses from the heart. Not just with your mouth, but with your heart.

This seems to mean so much to Him. It is meaning more to me all the time.

Anyway, that is what He said in tongues. The first half of that is what He said in tongues: He has been looking for a people who will manifest themselves in that kind of love. I think it is because of what He will be able to do through you.

Destroying people is not conducive to the walk of the Spirit. Neither is greed, hatred, and hurt. They are not conducive. But a person cannot stop all that stuff until he knows Him well enough to know that He will take care of him.

Go to Matthew, the twenty-second chapter. Then put a marker over in the epistle of John, 1 John. We will be over there in a moment.

Let us begin with Matthew 22:34. This is actually where we left off from the morning's teaching.

The Sadducees were sad, you see, because now the Pharisees heard that He had shut down the Sadducees. So no one really wanted to ask Him any questions. Finally a lawyer thought he knew something. He thought, "Well, I am a Pharisee. The others are Sadducees, but I can tempt Him."

It did not work.

Let us follow this for a moment:

But when the Pharisees had heard that he had put the Sadducees to silence, they were gathered together.

Then one of them, which was a lawyer, asked him a question, tempting him, and saying, Master, which is the great commandment in the law?

Jesus said unto him, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.

This is the first and great commandment.

And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

On these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets.

These verses have always been a mystery to me, because He says on these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets. What two?

Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.

This is the first and great commandment. The second great commandment is like it:

Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

He likens the love you are to love God with in the first and great commandment to loving your neighbor. He says loving your neighbor is like the first one. It is like the first one.

It is as though He is saying your love for God is not really your love for God unless you love your brethren, because the second one is like the first one. It is the same kind of love. You cannot love Him more than them, because it is the same kind of love.

He said all the law and the prophets hang on these two commandments.

Those might be the first two great commandments, okay. The problem was, I could not find them. I went over to the Ten Commandments and could not find them. Yet He said these are the two great commandments.

The lawyer was tempting Him: "What are they?"

Jesus said the first great commandment is to love the Lord your God with all your heart, mind, soul, and strength. The second great one is to love your neighbor as yourself.

I could not find that one either. So I am looking through the Ten Commandments. Thank God for Him expanding my mind so I can look at them without having to open my Bible. Thank God for meditation. I suggest it.

The first commandment is, "There shall be no other gods before you." The second is not to worship anything created. The third is not to take His name in vain. The fourth is to remember the Sabbath and keep it holy. What you are doing now, as you respect the new nature and walk by it, is keeping it holy.

Those are the first four, and I did not see it quoted there.

The next six change in nature. The fifth one is the first commandment with promise, which is to honor your father and mother. Jesus called it the first commandment with promise. Then, "Thou shalt not kill," "Thou shalt not commit adultery," "Thou shalt not steal," "Thou shalt not bear false witness," and "Thou shalt not covet."

Starting with honoring father and mother, all these are sins against each other: against your father and mother, murder, adultery, stealing, lying, and coveting.

When He said these are the two great commandments, the first four covered the commandment to love the Lord your God with all your heart, mind, soul, and strength. The second grouping, the six commandments, grouped together what it means not to hurt each other.

So He said if you keep these two, then you are keeping all the law and the prophets. Yes, because six of the commandments have to do with you hurting each other, and the first four have to do with loving the Lord your God with all your heart, mind, soul, and strength.

Loving your neighbor as yourself summed it up.

Even remembering the Sabbath and keeping it holy is involved. When you walk in that new nature, keep it holy, and keep that rest and peace, you highly honor God. He said, "By this shall men know that you are My disciples," that you love one another.

You honor God and keep the rest when you keep those commandments of love. All of it hinges on this.

Go on over to 1 John, because every time I read these five little chapters, I keep seeing him use being born of God, being saved, and love synonymously. It is the core nature of your Father.

God is love. He does not have love. He is. He does not have sovereignty. He is. He does not have faith. He is. He does not have immutability. He is immutable. He is. He is. He is.

So he uses this new nature He gave us synonymously with love.

When he said love never fails, and prophecies will cease and tongues will be done away with, why will they fail? Because they are revelation gifts. You only need them here when you have to be taught in your spirit in this walk of the flesh.

That is why he said love never fails. Prophecy and tongues will fail, which means when that which is perfect has come, they are not going on to heaven with you. You will not need them. But love is going over with you. That is why he said it never fails. It crosses the barrier because it is the core nature of what you received when you were born again.

God esteems it as the most lethal weapon you possess, because when you let the Holy Spirit cultivate that nature, your days of failure are over.

He seems to be synonymous here. He interchanges it. Every time he talks about love, he talks about loving your brother.

Even John, the apostle of love here, and even in these Ten Commandments, when Jesus answered the lawyer, the lawyer said, "You have rightly spoken. You are not far from the kingdom." When He answered the lawyer, He said the second great commandment encompasses the next six. It is like the first, that if you love the Lord your God with all your heart, mind, soul, and strength, you are going to love your neighbor as yourself. That is what makes it like the first.

If you are not loving your neighbor, you are not doing the first.

Look at 1 John 2:8:

Again, a new commandment I write unto you, which thing is true in him and in you: because the darkness is past, and the true light now shineth.

The darkness is past. You do not have a spiritually dead spirit anymore, and the true light now shines.

What happens when it shines? Synonymous with love again:

He that saith he is in the light, and hateth his brother, is in darkness even until now.

He that loveth his brother abideth in the light, and there is none occasion of stumbling in him.

But he that hateth his brother is in darkness, and walketh in darkness...

Even if you are not spiritually dead, you are walking like one because you cannot see where you are going.

...and knoweth not whither he goeth, because that darkness hath blinded his eyes.

One of the four most primary things in the leadership of the Spirit is to be guiltless and free:

I write unto you, little children, because your sins are forgiven you for his name's sake.

This gets real interesting, and one day we will clear all of this up for you. What I am after here is for you to notice how synonymous John thinks being born again and loving your brother are.

Poor John. He lived about 105 years, and he just got it in his mind. He got senile somewhere along the way and just thinks everybody who is saved should love their brother. He was probably about 102 when he started talking like that. He lost something. He is not listening to teaching anymore.

Well, let us go a little further.

Look at 1 John 4:16:

And we have known and believed the love that God hath to us. God is love; and he that dwelleth in love dwelleth in God, and God in him.

Herein is our love made perfect, that we may have boldness in the day of judgment...

Why?

...because as he is, so are we in this world.

I can stand boldly in the day of judgment. Why? Because my love is being perfected. My house is not being perfected. As He is, so are we in this world. He is talking about His humanity. Jesus glorified humanity again. He is at the right hand of the Father with a human spirit that has the same nature in it as yours does: divine nature, love, human spirit, divine nature of love.

I can have boldness in the day of judgment because herein is His love perfected. How? As He is, so are we in this world. I am standing on this planet. He is at the right hand of the Father. But as He is in that new nature, I am standing in this world with that new nature.

When I perfect that love, I can have boldness in the day of judgment because when you cultivate that kind of love, you are going to end up with the best God has. That is all there is to it.

You may make it past servant to slave, where Jesus literally owns you and your whole life has been surrendered.

Moving on:

Herein is our love made perfect, that we may have boldness in the day of judgment...

We can get that love perfected because it has been planted in us. We are here, and He is there. But we have the same life in our human spirit that He has seated there.

He explains the nature of it a little bit in verse 18:

There is no fear in love; but perfect love casteth out fear: because fear hath torment.

Boy, I am glad He told me that.

He that feareth is not made perfect in love.

We love him, because he first loved us.

Here goes that synonymous saying again. Poor John. He has lost it.

If a man say, I love God, and hateth his brother, he is a liar.

The second commandment is like the first.

If a man says, "I love God," and hates his brother, he is a liar.

For he that loveth not his brother whom he hath seen, how can he love God whom he hath not seen?

And this commandment have we from him, That he who loveth God love his brother also.

He did not say maybe you would.

"Well, I am just so in love with God."

"My little wife? Shut up. But I am so in love with God."

Yes, you are. Oh yes, you are.

Last summer I was on television because he had been casting out devils. The show host asked him, "Are you telling me I am demon possessed? Are you telling me that?"

Old Lester said, "I do not know. Ask your wife."

I tell you whose prayers God answers: the prayers of the guy who lives at home, not the one on the outing, not the one at the church picnic.

John says if you cannot love your brother, whom you can see, how can you love God, whom you cannot see?

I thought, "God, that is just the point. I can love You because I cannot see You. You are not putting a knife in my back every other day. You are not treating me mean. That is why."

But obviously Somebody convinced John that having the new nature is synonymous with love for your brother, and loving God is synonymous with loving your brother. You cannot have one without the other.

Do you love God?

"I hate you."

No, you do not.

He that loves Him who begot loves him who is begotten of Him.

Do you love your brother? Do you love your brother? Do you really?

That is the core nature of His love. If you are born again, that is what will keep trying to show up and end up manifesting.